

If you belong to the latter category, the lowest end model will be more than enough for your needs, but if you take photography seriously and would prefer to have options to tweak every setting that affects your image, you may want to shell out a bit more for that slightly better 'prosumer' camera.

### The Megapixel Myth

First things first—higher megapixel count is in no way a measure of the quality of your pictures. Quality is determined by the image



#### INFO

CCD stands for Charge Coupled Device and CMOS is Complementary Metal Oxide Semiconductor. They are the two most-used sensors in digital cameras. Most consumer cameras use CCDs because they offer better image quality. Some professional cameras, though, are now employing CMOS sensors since the power consumption is less.

sensor; megapixel count simply denotes how big your image would be. For any home user who wants to post snapshots on the Internet or print them on a maximum of an A4 size photo paper does not need anything more than a 3-megapixel camera.

Though the megapixel count does not directly relate to image quality, it is noticed that the higher megapixel cameras have more professional features, hence they are generally more expensive.

Amateur photographers and prosumers may want to invest in a 4-5 megapixel camera for some of its advanced options. We have listed a guideline as to what megapixel count would be suitable for a particular sized print. You can choose your type of camera based on the size of your prints.

Ready Reckoner: Mega-pixel count vis-à-vis Print size

|     |                 |    |                 |
|-----|-----------------|----|-----------------|
| 3MP | 5 x 7 inches    | to | 8 x 10 inches   |
| 4MP | 8 x 10 inches   | to | 8.5 x 11 inches |
| 5MP | 8.5 x 11 inches | to | 9 x 12 inches   |
| 6MP | 9 x 12 inches   | to | 11 x 14 inches  |
| 8MP | 14 x 17 inches  | to | 16 x 20 inches  |